

Kingdom of Saudi Arabia · Central Region

Real Estate Market Report Al-Qassim Region

Strategic analysis and market dynamics for 2026

An institutional reading of Al-Qassim's office, residential, retail, industrial and hospitality sectors, plus regulation, transactions and opportunity maps.

Offices

Residential

Retail

Industrial

Hotels

Regulation

Deals

Maps

Nine themes covering the Al-Qassim real estate market

From macro indicators to executable opportunities, in the order an investor reads the market.

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Ten opportunities · Investor matrix · Takamol services · Real Forsa & Real Invest

How this report was built and what sets it apart

Data sources

Real Estate Registry and Ministry of Justice (transactions), GASTAT, the Real Estate General Authority (REGA), Al-Qassim Municipality, the Saudi Authority for Industrial Cities (MODON), the Ministry of Tourism, NHC and developer announcements, benchmarked against international consultancies (JLL, Knight Frank, CBRE).

Analytical approach

2026 values are estimated from transaction data and field surveys to mid-year and compared with each indicator's annual change. Every sector is then linked to its drivers (food and agri-industries, industrial cities, the airport and rail station, festivals) to derive actionable recommendations for developers and investors.

What makes a Takamol report different

Analysis at governorate, corridor and district level rather than region alone; genuine geographic maps of Buraydah, Unaizah and the governorates; and figures linked to automated feasibility studies in Real Invest and curated opportunities in Real Forsa — a decision tool, not just a market read.

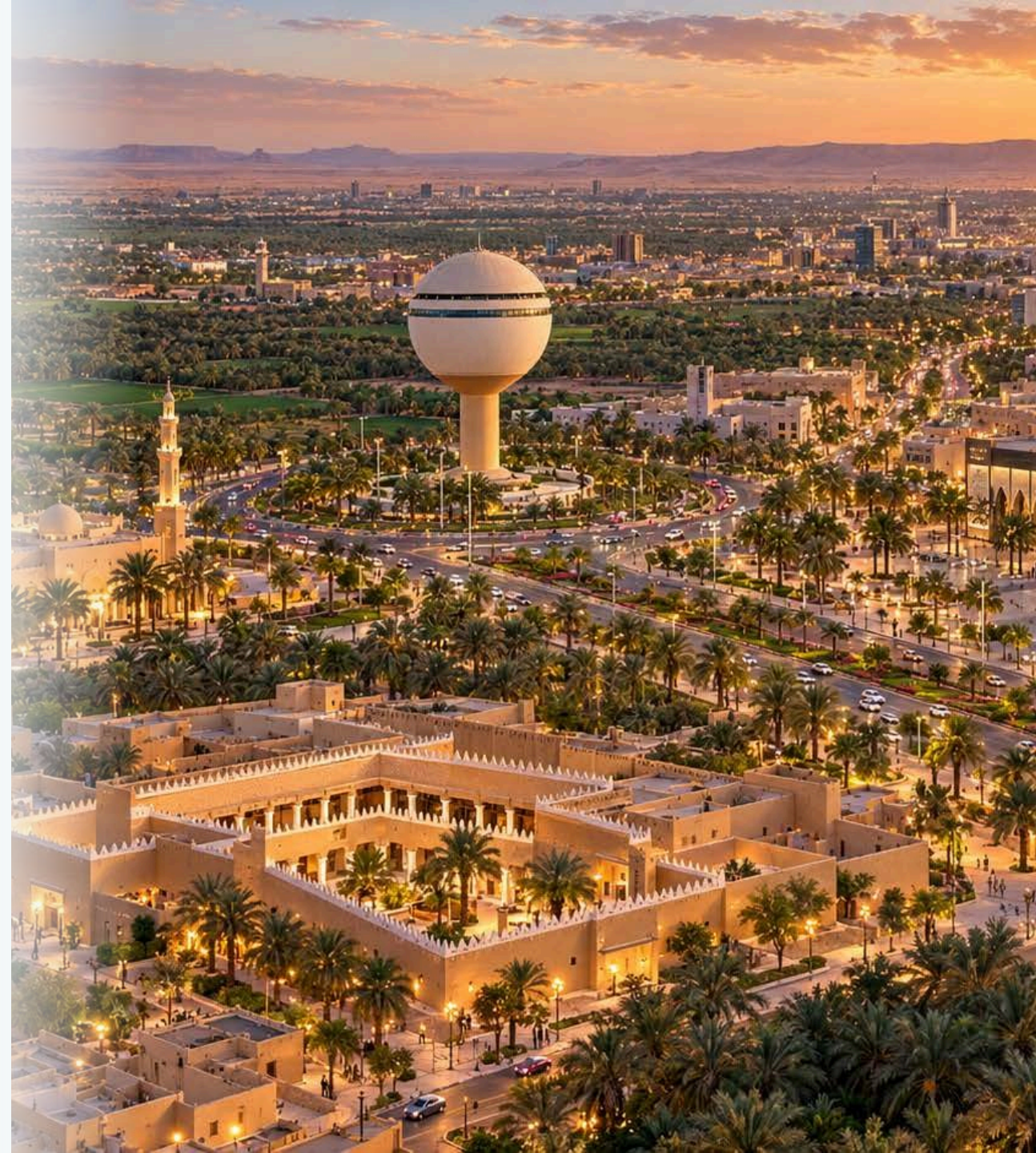
Scope: Al-Qassim Region and its thirteen governorates, focusing on Buraydah, Unaizah, Ar Rass, Al Bukayriyah, Al Badayea and Al Mithnab · Reference period: January – August 2026.

Units and comparison: values in Saudi riyals (SAR) unless stated otherwise · annual rates compare with the same period of 2025 (YoY) · estimated figures are marked "c." or "around".

01

Executive Summary & Key Performance Indicators

Demographics & purchasing power · Investment programmes & capital flows · Mega-project map · Global events · Business confidence & construction costs · Return–risk matrix



Macro indicators: a growing industrial, logistics and agri hub

1.34M

residents — Al-Qassim population base

13

governorates — broad administrative diversity

1,800 MW

capacity of the Qassim 1 solar project

730

operating factories — 4.7% of the Kingdom's total

A growing industrial and logistics hub at the heart of the Kingdom

Al-Qassim is a significant industrial and logistics centre, benefiting from a strategic position between several major regions and from a road network integrated with Qassim rail station and Prince Nayef bin Abdulaziz International Airport. The industrial base is concentrated in food, pharmaceutical, metal, plastic and chemical products, alongside activities tied to agriculture and dates.

The region hosts around 730 factories across diverse activities. Qassim Industrial City 1 benefits from proximity to the airport and rail station, supporting freight and distribution to markets across central, northern and western Saudi Arabia.

The supply–demand gap

Al-Qassim is seeing growing demand for modern warehouses and industrial and logistics facilities, driven by growth in food, agricultural and industrial activity, e-commerce and regional distribution.

Indicators point to clear pressure on organised industrial supply: occupancy in Industrial City 1 in Buraydah reached around 96% in 2025, while average occupancy across the region's industrial cities stood at around 77% in mid-2025 — a divergence that favours sites with the best readiness and service connectivity.

Takeaway: a market that rewards readiness and location — serviced sites near the airport and rail station fill first, at a premium.

Demographics, purchasing power and income patterns

15,470

SAR — average monthly household income

2.31%

annual population growth

1.34M

residents — a young, growing population base

+11,000

SAR — average monthly wage of Saudi employees

Target segments and their property behaviour

Young Saudi families: local households on middle to upper-middle incomes seeking stability and housing quality; they prefer villas and modern units within integrated districts close to schools, services and shopping centres.

Professional, academic and healthcare staff: employees of government bodies, Qassim University, the health sector and industrial firms; demand for modern apartments and serviced units near employment and service hubs in Buraydah and Unaizah.

Local business owners and investors: a commercial, agricultural and industrial base with surplus capital directed to investment; buying land, residential and commercial units and warehouses for letting or development and recurring income.

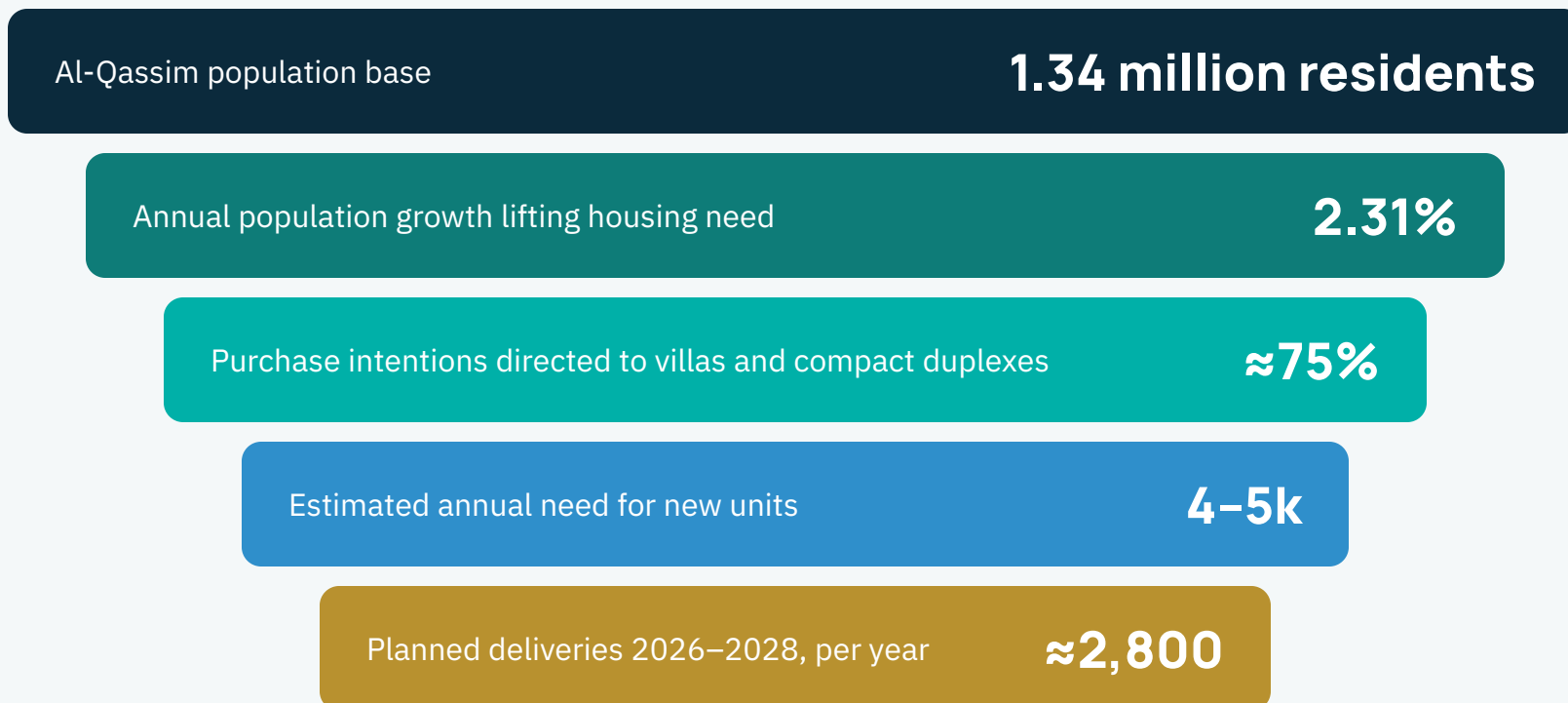
Takamol view

A young population with household income above SAR 15k per month drives demand towards compact villas and duplexes (around 75% of purchase intentions), with young families gradually shifting to modern apartments in Buraydah and Unaizah.

Individual investors lean towards apartments, small villas and shop units on active corridors and fast-growing areas, seeking stable assets, relatively lower risk and attractive rental yields.

Product window: 250–350 sqm units for families and serviced 1–3 bedroom apartments for professionals — this is the heart of demand in Al-Qassim.

Demand funnel: from population base to the housing unit required



Reading the funnel

A young, growing population converts into structural demand for compact villas and modern apartments in Buraydah and Unaizah, reinforced by the expanding industrial base, Qassim University and the health sector.

Supply scheduled for delivery in 2026–2028 totals around 8,500 units (c. 2,800 per year), covering roughly 55%–70% of estimated annual need — which explains the continued, measured growth in prices and rents.

Estimated annual gap: 1,200 – 2,200 units

Source: GASTAT, Real Estate Registry, developer announcements (NHC and private sector) and Takamol analysis. Annual need is an estimate.

Regional headquarters programme and capital flows

14.3K

property transactions worth SAR 5.03bn

700M

SAR — new industrial investment in Q1 2025

96%

occupancy at Industrial City 1, Buraydah

8.5–9.2%

target net yields for logistics and cold-chain assets

International investment appeal

Invest Saudi: 47 quality investment opportunities were offered in Buraydah in Q1 2026 across industry, education, healthcare and leisure and commercial facilities, alongside more than SAR 2.2bn of municipal and development projects injected during 2025.

Investment in logistics assets and cold storage for the food and pharmaceutical industries is delivering target net yields of 8.5% to 9.2%, making the region a preferred destination for international investors and real estate funds.

Industrial and logistics investment strength

Al-Qassim has a growing industrial and logistics base built on food, agricultural, pharmaceutical and manufacturing industries, supported by its central location and a modern road network linking it to Riyadh and the rest of the Kingdom.

Qassim Industrial Cities 1 and 2 underpin this activity, together with their proximity to Prince Nayef bin Abdulaziz International Airport and Qassim rail station; the dates and agricultural trade is one of the region's main logistics drivers.

New investment: SAR 2.2bn+ of municipal and development projects in 2025, with a continuing pipeline of industrial, commercial, logistics and service opportunities.

Mega-project map – Al-Qassim Region 2026

1 Qassim 1 Solar Project

North of Buraydah · 1,800 MW · one of the Kingdom's largest renewable projects · driver for energy-intensive industry

2 Buraydah Dry Port

West of Buraydah · direct link to Qassim rail station and the airport · distribution hub for central and northern KSA

3 Industrial Cities 1 & 2

Buraydah · 580+ factories · 96% occupancy in City 1 · food, pharmaceutical, metal and plastic industries

4 Palm Processing Project – Unaizah

Unaizah · 500k sqm · clustering dates and agri-product processing, cold chains and packaging

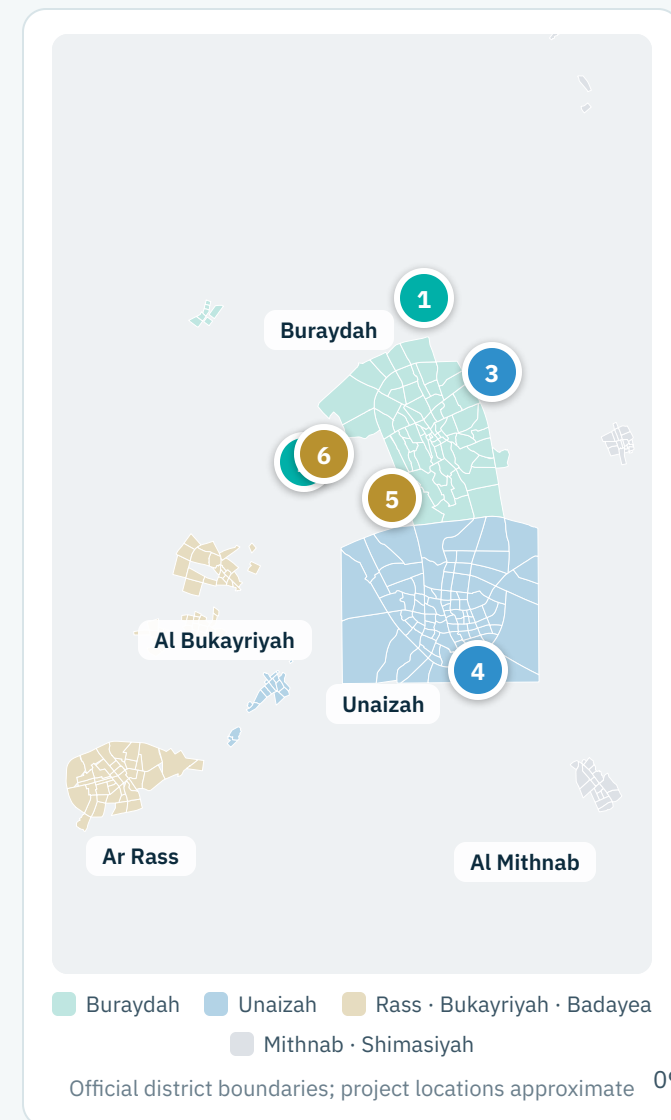
5 Qassim Camel Racetrack

9m+ sqm · events, heritage and festival destination supporting seasonal hotel demand

6 Prince Nayef Airport & Rail Station

Comprehensive airport redevelopment · 1.13m passengers to Aug 2025 (+20.8%) · backbone of connectivity

Investment takeaway: mega-projects cluster on the Buraydah–Unaizah corridor: energy, industry and logistics to the north and west, agri-processing south in Unaizah — linked by airport, rail and expressway.



Global events as investment catalysts

Vision 2030 targets, transport and tourism

Prince Nayef bin Abdulaziz International Airport: 1.13m passengers to August 2025, up +20.8%, with a comprehensive redevelopment including a new terminal and upgraded airside infrastructure.

Hospitality and leisure: 45.6% hotel occupancy in Q1 2025 and an average stay of 1.7 nights · 72 parks in Buraydah + 41 walkways across Al-Qassim · growing support for tourism, leisure and quality of life.

Public transport: 16 bus routes · 217 stops · 73 buses · 974 km of routes linking Buraydah, Unaizah and the governorates.

FIFA World Cup 2034 — training camps and support venues

National team camps

Al-Qassim's central location and air and road links to Riyadh make it a candidate for training camps and sports facilities

Hospitality and serviced apartments

Rising demand for hotels, serviced apartments, restaurants, retail and leisure as domestic travel increases

Rural and heritage tourism

Scope to develop rural lodges and farm and oasis experiences in Unaizah, Al Bukayriyah and Al Badayea

Mass events

Buraydah Dates Festival, Al Ghada Festival and the Gulf festivals — a platform for tournament side-events

1.13M

passengers — Prince Nayef Airport traffic to Aug 2025 (+20.8%)

974 km

public transport routes · 16 routes · 217 stops · 73 buses

113 sites

72 parks in Buraydah + 41 walkways in Al-Qassim — leisure and quality-of-life infrastructure

6,120

licensed hospitality keys: 1,901 hotel + 3,219 apartments + other categories

Al-Qassim roadmap 2026–2034: the milestones that reprice the market

Each delivery milestone adds quality supply or opens a new wave of demand — its timing defines the investor's entry window.

2026

47 opportunities offered in Buraydah · U Walk Qassim opens (60k sqm GLA) in Q4 · new Unaizah mall awarded (SAR 85m)

2028

2026–2028 delivery wave completes: c. 8,500 homes · new Unaizah mall completes · Tijan phase two (c. 1m sqm)

2030

Vision 2030 targets: renewables (Qassim 1) · rural tourism and festivals · public transport network complete (974 km)

2027

First NHC suburban phase delivered north of Buraydah · modern office space grows in Tijan · serviced apartments expand

2028–2030

Residential planning phase: +12,600 units · Industrial City 2 and dry port expand · Prince Nayef Airport upgrade

2034

World Cup: training camps and support facilities · peak demand for hospitality, serviced apartments and leisure retail

Business confidence, construction costs and building permits

892

investment contracts signed by Al-Qassim Municipality in 2025, worth over SAR 239m

+2.3%

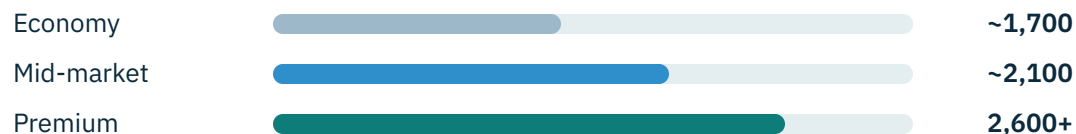
rise in Kingdom-wide construction costs 2025–2026 — national indicator

580

factories in Al-Qassim's industrial cities · c. 77% occupancy

Average construction and finishing cost

1,700–2,600

 SAR / sqm

A relatively stable development environment: despite rising national construction costs, Al-Qassim remains a market of opportunity in residential, commercial, warehousing and logistics projects, supported by local building-material, concrete and metal plants that reduce supply risk.

Modern Methods of Construction (MMC) change project economics

30–35%

shorter build times with precast and modular units

18 → 8–10

months — residential build time with modular construction

-35%

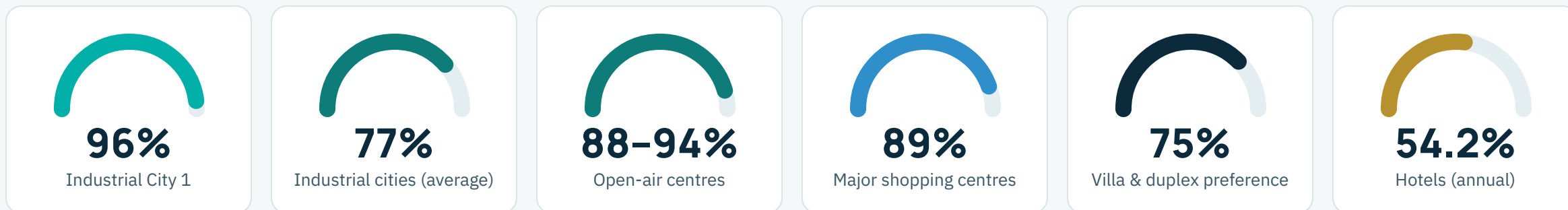
cooling consumption with advanced insulation for Al-Qassim's continental climate

22–28%

target gross development margin

Al-Qassim offers a suitable base for expanding precast and modern construction methods, particularly given local building-material, concrete and metal plants — opening opportunities to develop precast solutions and prefabricated structural elements.

Occupancy gauges: a market running at high capacity



What do the gauges mean?

An industrial market close to full capacity in serviced locations (96% at Industrial City 1) versus a 77% average across the other industrial cities — demand concentrates on readiness and location, not floor area alone. In retail, open-air centres (88–94%) outperform enclosed malls (82–89%) on both occupancy and rent.

Where is the opportunity?

The gap between annual hotel occupancy (54.2%) and festival peaks (85–92%) rewards flexible assets convertible between hotel and serviced-living use, while the gap between serviced and unserviced industrial cities rewards ready-built Grade A warehousing near the airport and rail station.

Return vs risk matrix: where each sector stands in Al-Qassim 2026

Warehousing & cold-chain logistics 8.5–9.2%

Shopping centres & neighbourhood retail 7.5–8.5%

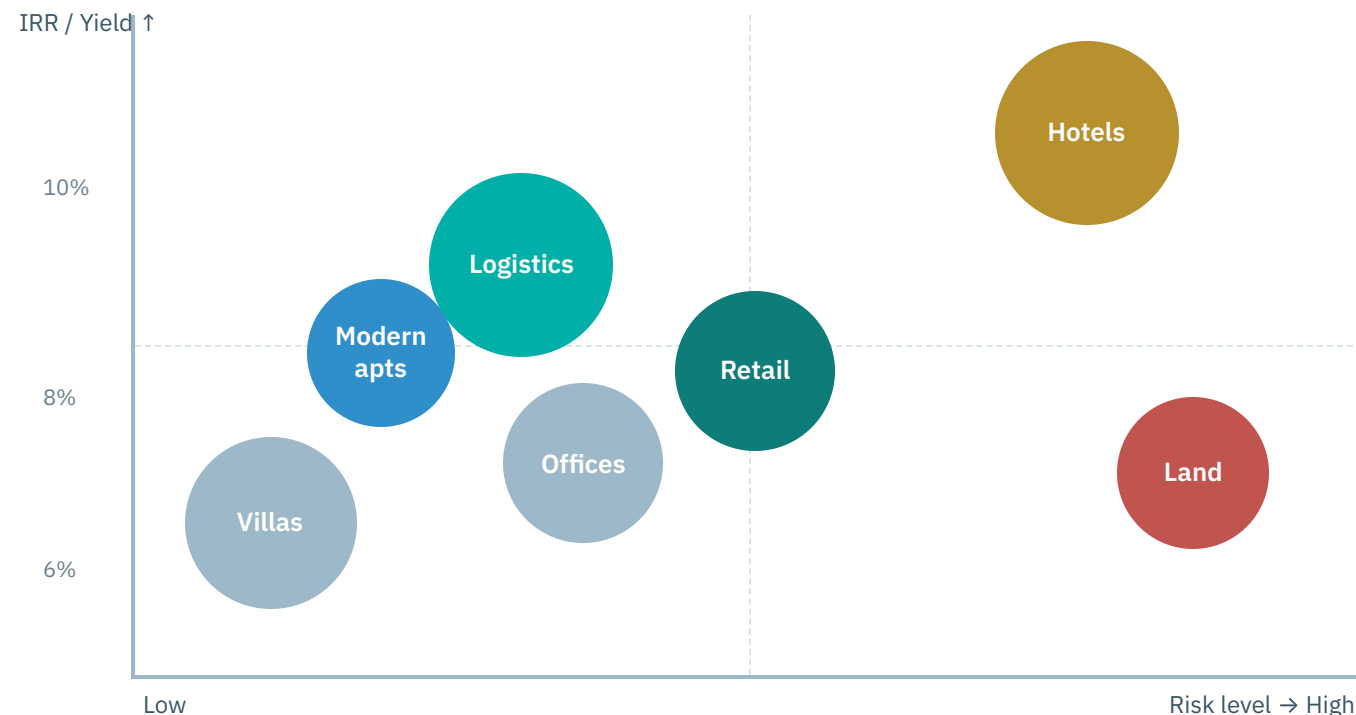
Modern apartments (Buraydah & Unaizah) 7.5–9.0%

Modern offices 7.0–8.0%

Compact villas (residential) 6.0–7.0%

Hotels (expected IRR) 12–19%

Raw land Capital / long cycle



Bubble size reflects market depth (transactions and supply) · positioning is indicative, based on this report's indicators · logistics and food cold-chain combine the highest net yield with the highest occupancy in Al-Qassim.

02

Office & Administrative Space

Stock & occupancy · Supply and demand dynamics · Rent map by corridor · Institutional demand segments · Transport connectivity · Opportunities & outlook



Office market dashboard: a specialised local market modernising

700M

SAR — new industrial investment in Q1 2025

77%

occupancy across Al-Qassim industrial cities

1bn

SAR — development fund for U Walk Qassim / Tijan

+11.1%

annual growth in commercial lease transactions

Occupancy by grade

Market dynamics: Al-Qassim's office market is a specialised local one driven by the needs of large family groups, food and healthcare headquarters, consulting and education entities and professional-services firms — unlike the multinational pattern concentrated in Riyadh.

Modern offices		97%
Mid-grade offices		86%
Traditional offices		75%

Takamol view

Although the region has no unified institutional Grade A classification, modern administrative space within mixed-use schemes is seeing marked demand growth (+11.1% YoY in commercial lease transactions).

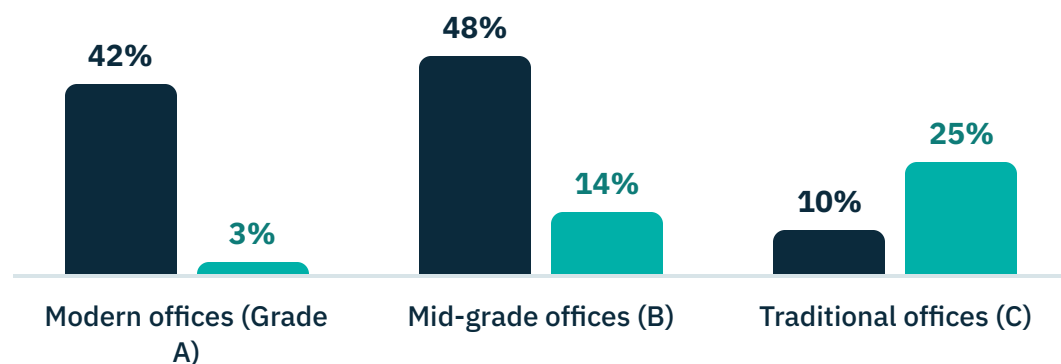
The highest rents are on Buraydah's main corridors (King Abdullah, King Fahd and King Salman roads) at indicative SAR 400–620/sqm/yr for modern buildings, while Unaizah records SAR 300–420/sqm/yr for new buildings.

Entry window: until the Tijan scheme completes (c. 1m sqm mixed-use, 2027–2028), existing modern buildings on the main corridors hold a strong pricing position.

Supply and demand dynamics and the future pipeline

Share of supply vs vacancy rate

■ Share of supply ■ Vacancy rate



Takamol estimates based on the 2026 market survey · vacancy concentrates in traditional buildings while modern space is close to full.

47

investment opportunities offered in Buraydah, Q1 2026

~1M sqm

Tijan mixed-use scheme 2027–2028

400–620

SAR/sqm/yr — modern buildings in Buraydah

+11.1%

annual growth in commercial lease transactions

Outlook 2026–2028

2026: gradual expansion of commercial and mixed supply · 2027–2028: growth in mixed-use schemes (Tijan). Demand: small and medium offices + professional services + local headquarters. Direction: a clear preference for modern buildings and prime locations, with gradual pressure on traditional buildings carrying high vacancy.

Rent map by area and corridor

Area / corridor	Modern offices	Traditional offices	Rent level	YoY change
North Buraydah — King Abdullah / King Salman	620 SAR	400 SAR		+3.0%
Central Buraydah and secondary corridors	450 SAR	320 SAR		+1.5%
Unaizah — Zamil Al-Sulaim / Prince Sultan	420 SAR	300 SAR		+1.2%
Ar Rass — centre and main corridors	320 SAR	220 SAR		+0.8%
Al Bukayriyah and other governorates	260 SAR	180 SAR		+0.5%

Upper-bound annual rent in SAR per sqm · bar index relative to the top corridor (North Buraydah = 100%).

2.4×

rent gap between North Buraydah (620) and the other governorates (260) for modern buildings

Reading the corridors

North Buraydah and main corridors:

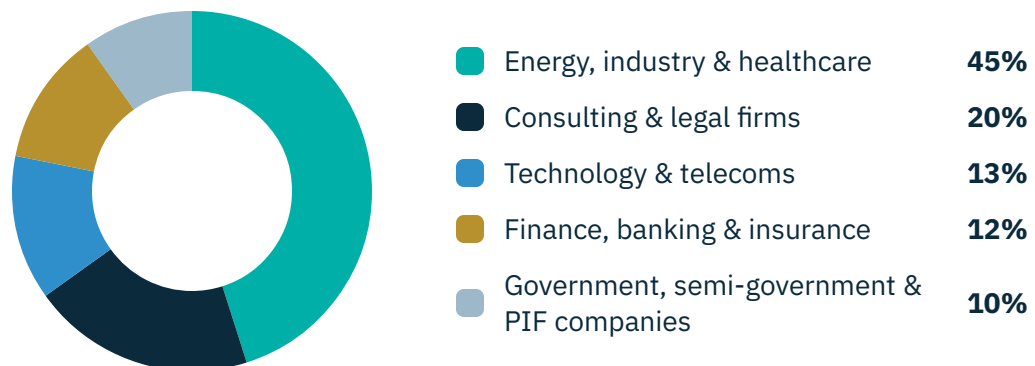
highest demand and value — family groups, food conglomerates and the health sector.

Central Buraydah and Unaizah: stable to positive; mature buildings that reward refurbishment and flexible offices.

Ar Rass and the governorates: a limited local market built on professional services and single-occupier premises.

Institutional demand segments and shifting tenant requirements

Institutional office demand in Al-Qassim, 2026



Takamol estimates based on the 2026 market survey.

Demand for newer, more efficient buildings

+11.1% Al-Qassim's office market is gradually shifting to newer buildings in fit-out, services, parking and accessibility, especially in Buraydah and on the main commercial corridors.

Flexible offices and co-working

Flex Growing interest in flexible offices and co-working for small businesses and entrepreneurs, particularly near Qassim University and Buraydah's business hubs.

What does the institutional tenant look for in Al-Qassim?

Ample parking · frontage on a main corridor · flexible floor plates · proximity to banking and government services · and, for industrial occupiers, proximity to the airport, industrial city and rail station.

Transport connectivity: the Buraydah–Unaizah corridor

Al-Qassim benefits from its central location and a network linking Buraydah, Unaizah and the main governorates with Qassim rail station, Prince Nayef International Airport and the expressways. As public transport expands in Buraydah and Unaizah (16 routes, 217 stops), access to commercial, service and industrial hubs improves and main-corridor sites grow more attractive.

700M

SAR — industrial investment Q1 2025

47

investment opportunities offered in Buraydah

158

factories in Industrial City 1

77%

industrial city occupancy

Impact on offices: corridors served by public transport and close to the airport and rail station attract the headquarters of industrial and food companies — mapping future office demand.



Investment opportunities, challenges and outlook

1

Transport connectivity

Al-Qassim benefits from its central location, expressways and rail, Qassim rail station and Prince Nayef Airport, with public transport expanding in Buraydah and Unaizah — improving access to commercial, service and industrial hubs and strengthening the appeal of investment locations.

2

Land cost and development cycle

Price pressure concentrates in prime locations within Buraydah and Unaizah and on the commercial corridors and major roads, calling for selectivity in site choice and development phasing, especially for commercial, office and mixed-use schemes.

3

Pre-leasing and ESG standards

Pre-leasing is increasingly important for new schemes in Al-Qassim to lower development risk and improve financing feasibility, alongside growing attention to energy efficiency, indoor environmental quality, sustainability and smart building operation.

4

Outlook: new-supply pressure

As commercial and mixed-use schemes arrive in phases (Tijan, U Walk), competition between new and existing assets intensifies; modern buildings with good parking and prime locations will keep a clear edge over traditional stock in attracting tenants.

03

Residential & Housing Market

Residential dashboard · Future supply and suburban schemes · Price map by zone · Emerging products and construction technology · Investment outlook and yields



Operating dashboard and housing market in Al-Qassim Region

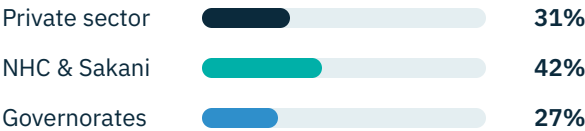
Residential / financial indicator	Current value (2026)	Annual change	Statistical analysis and data sources
Total existing residential stock	345,000 occupied housing units	+1.8% to +2.2%	Buraydah holds c. 180k units, Unaizah c. 65k and Ar Rass c. 40k; the remainder is spread across Al Bukayriyah, Al Mithnab, Al Badayea and Riyadh Al Khabra.
Average apartment price per sqm	SAR 1,900 – 2,850/sqm	+1.2%	Northern Buraydah districts (Al Rayyan, Al Nahda, Al Rehab) lead at SAR 2,400–2,850/sqm, Unaizah (Al Fakhriya, Al Ashrafiya) at 2,100–2,600; Ar Rass and the governorates at 1,500–2,000.
Average villa price per sqm	SAR 2,300 – 3,600/sqm	+1.6%	Firm family demand for detached villas and modern duplexes on compact plots (250–350 sqm) in north and west Buraydah and Unaizah; stable prices in new schemes backed by housing programmes.
Sales volume and demand mix	14,000+ transactions (2026)	-5.4%	Villas, duplexes and residential plots exceed 78% of purchase intentions, while modern apartment trading grows steadily among young households and education and medical staff.
Regional share of residential mortgages	4.5% – 5.0%	Broadly stable	Sixth in the Kingdom by volume of residential mortgage contracts for individuals; finance is heavily weighted to buying and self-building villas rather than apartments.

Al-Qassim's residential market is growing steadily and in balance, driven by a social preference for the detached home and a gradual shift among young families to modern and compact duplex designs. Buraydah and Unaizah carry the weight of property and investment activity, while NHC schemes and off-plan (Wafi) licences expand supply at prices suited to middle incomes.

Future supply, suburban schemes and housing development

Zone / developer	Delivery 2026–28	Pipeline 2028–30	Products offered
Azyan and North Buraydah (NHC and partners)	1,450 units	+2,800 units	Integrated communities of detached villas and modern townhouses with parks.
Buraydah western suburbs (Sakani and NHC)	2,100 units	+3,500 units	Ready family villas, self-build plots and affordable townhouses.
Unaizah Governorate (housing and residential schemes)	1,200 units	+1,800 units	Detached villas, modern duplexes and small buildings for individual ownership.
Ar Rass, Al Bukayriyah and Al Mithnab (Ministry and private)	1,150 units	+1,500 units	Affordable schemes and individual villas for family demand in the governorates.
Private sector and off-plan sales (Buraydah and Unaizah)	2,600 units	Ongoing (+3,000)	Wafi-licensed off-plan schemes, compact premium apartments and gated communities.
Total supply capacity	8,500 units	+12,600 units	75% villas and townhouses, 25% modern apartments — matching Al-Qassim's social profile.

2026–2028 deliveries by developer



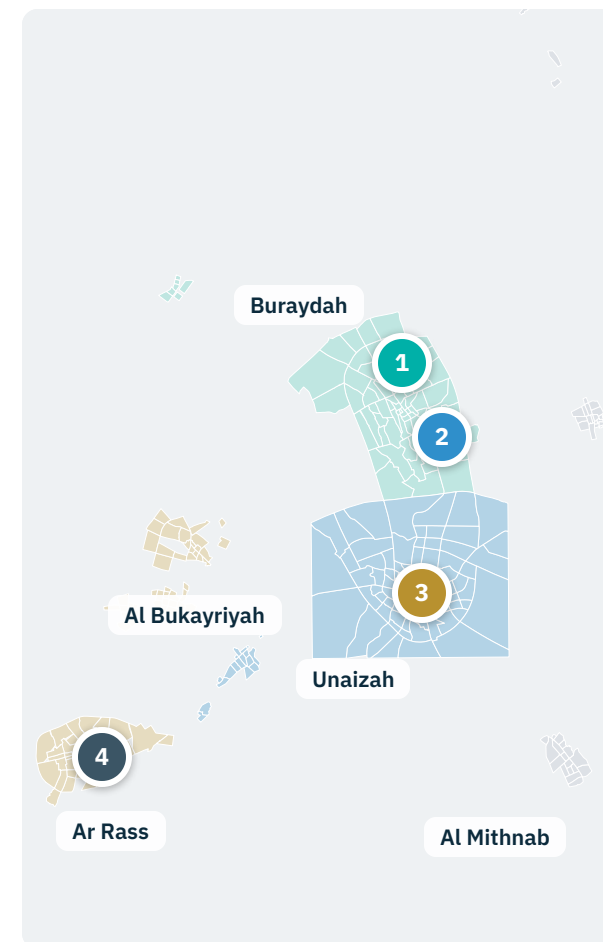
Need vs supply

Housing development plans in Al-Qassim target more than 8,500 units by end-2028. NHC, in partnership with local developers, leads organised supply with a share above 55%, narrowing the price gap and offering modern, sustainable ownership products that meet household aspirations.

Price map and geographic comparison across Al-Qassim's four zones

North Buraydah corridor Most sought-after and premium zone	Al Rayyan, Al Nahda, Al Rehab, Al Ufuq, Sultanah, Al Hamr	Apartments (SAR/sqm) 2,400 – 3,100	Villas (SAR/sqm) 3,200 – 4,600
Central and south/east Buraydah Commercial and ring-road corridor	Al Safra, Al Iskan, Al Rafiah, Al Fayziyah, Mishal, Al Qadisiyah	Apartments (SAR/sqm) 1,800 – 2,400	Villas (SAR/sqm) 2,300 – 3,200
Unaizah Governorate corridor Central districts and northern expansion	Al Fakhriya, Al Wafa, Al Ashrafiya, Al Shifa, Al Nuzha, Al Khuzama	Apartments (SAR/sqm) 2,000 – 2,650	Villas (SAR/sqm) 2,700 – 3,800
Governorates zone Ar Rass, Al Bukayriyah, Al Mithnab, Al Badayea	Al Jawazat and Al Quds (Ar Rass), Al Rabwa (Al Bukayriyah), Al Khalidiya (Al Mithnab)	Apartments (SAR/sqm) 1,400 – 1,950	Villas (SAR/sqm) 1,900 – 2,700

Spatial trend: the North Buraydah corridor and Unaizah's northern expansion districts lead residential and investment prices, driven by complete infrastructure and quality amenities, while east and south Buraydah and Al Bukayriyah drive affordable transaction volumes and fit housing-support budgets for Saudi families. The gap between the top and bottom zones is around 1.7×.



Actual district boundaries of Buraydah, Unaizah and the governorates · coloured by city

Emerging residential products and modern development technology

Rising residential formats in Al-Qassim

● Compact Modern Villas and economy duplexes

Considered plot sizes (250–350 sqm) and smart standalone built areas (280–340 sqm) that meet modern families' wish for full independence and privacy in north Buraydah and Unaizah, while cutting build, running and maintenance costs versus large traditional villas.

● Modern Boutique Apartments for professionals

Compact residential buildings with modern finishes, private parking and smart lifts, targeting clinicians at the Health Cluster, Qassim University faculty and government staff — delivering attractive rental yields of 7.5% to 9.0%.

● Agri-Residential Living and family retreats

Leveraging Al-Qassim's rural and agricultural character with family retreats and rural lodges in a contemporary Najdi style, meeting demand for periodic stays and rural tourism while preserving the region's architectural identity.

Modern Methods of Construction (MMC)

8–10 months instead of 18

Precast concrete and modular systems

Shortening the delivery cycle for residential and large suburban schemes in step with housing-support deliveries in Buraydah and Unaizah.

-35% cooling consumption

Advanced insulation for a dry continental climate

High-performance insulation to Saudi Building Code standards against Al-Qassim's sharp temperature swings (hot summers, cold winters), cutting energy use and extending the home's service life.

Residential investment outlook, challenges and recommendations

Strategic theme	Ground reality and analysis (Al-Qassim)	Actionable recommendation for developers and investors
Compact villas and duplexes	The detached home remains the preference of over 75% of households in Buraydah and the governorates, with declining appetite for very large traditional villas (500+ sqm).	Design smart villa and duplex models on 250–320 sqm plots at prices matched to household financing capacity (SAR 850k – 1.25m).
Apartments in Buraydah and Unaizah	Gradually rising apartment demand from newlyweds, relocated employees and clinicians near the universities and business hubs.	Focus on 3–4 bedroom apartments with dedicated parking, lifts and smart security to ensure fast absorption and easy resale and letting.
Off-plan sales (Wafi)	Growing institutional awareness of Wafi licences in protecting buyers and ensuring quality and engineering oversight.	Use Wafi licensing to self-finance schemes through the escrow account, easing bank-finance burdens and lifting marketing appeal.
Suburban land and infrastructure	Uneven readiness of utility networks and amenities between central zones and peripheral expansion schemes in Buraydah and Unaizah.	Form development partnerships with major raw-land owners, or draw on infrastructure delivered by Al-Qassim Municipality and NHC.
Institutional housing and rental investment	Growth in logistics, healthcare and food and agri manufacturing creates stable demand for staff rental housing.	Invest in Build-to-Rent communities with long-term leases to key sectors, securing a sustainable recurring cash flow.

Al-Qassim's residential landscape is maturing institutionally with a focus on economic efficiency: the traditional preference for the detached home meets modern construction through compact villas and duplexes, while expanding support programmes and off-plan sales open promising opportunities for developers to build high-quality communities with low operating risk.

Takamol view: where does residential return concentrate?

An illustrative example built on the average prices and rents in this report — not an investment offer; detailed studies are run through Real Invest.

Model A

Modern apartment for professionals, Buraydah

Near the Health Cluster / University · 110 sqm

Indicative price per sqm	SAR 2,600
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Unit value	SAR 286,000
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Annual rent	SAR 24,000
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Gross yield

8.4%

Est. net 7.5%–9.0% · highest yield and fastest letting to professionals

Model B

Compact duplex, North Buraydah

Al Rayyan / Al Nahda · 300 sqm plot · 320 sqm built

Indicative price per sqm	SAR 3,900
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Unit value	SAR 1,250,000
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Annual rent	SAR 80,000
-------------	-------------------

Gross yield

6.4%

Est. net 5.8%–6.5% · most saleable to families and housing-support beneficiaries

Model C

Family villa, Unaizah

Al Fakhriya / Al Ashrafiya · 350 sqm plot

Indicative price per sqm	SAR 3,300
--------------------------	------------------

Unit value	SAR 1,150,000
------------	----------------------

Annual rent	SAR 70,000
-------------	-------------------

Gross yield

6.1%

Est. net 5.5%–6.2% · high rental stability and steady family demand

04

Retail & Shopping Centres

Dashboard · Major retail delivery map · Four pillars of demand ·
Enclosed malls vs open-air centres · Distribution by corridor · Strategy
pyramid



General and operating dashboard for Al-Qassim's retail market

41K sqm

GLA of Al Nakheel Mall, Buraydah —
the leading existing centre

60K sqm

GLA of U Walk Qassim · 135 stores ·
Q4 2026

~89%

occupancy of major shopping
centres 2026 (national benchmark)

850–1,600

SAR/sqm — rent in modern open-air
centres

Existing lettable space and occupancy

Al-Qassim has several main shopping centres in Buraydah and Unaizah, led by Al Nakheel Mall in Buraydah at around 41k sqm GLA, plus Unaizah Plaza at around 7,804 sqm. With U Walk Qassim (60k sqm GLA) arriving, the market is shifting towards more modern destinations combining retail, dining and leisure.

No published institutional indicator exists for average mall occupancy across Al-Qassim; the c. 89% average for 2026 is therefore used as a national benchmark, not a direct figure for the region.

Open-air centres		88–94%
Enclosed regional malls		82–89%

Takamol view

Al-Qassim's retail market is heading towards more organised, modern supply, notably with U Walk Qassim in Buraydah within the Tijan scheme and the new Unaizah mall (60k sqm) — raising competition on experience quality and the tenant and leisure mix rather than conventional shopping.

Restaurants, cafés and leisure are increasingly central to modern retail destinations, with new schemes blending shopping, dining and family events.

Opportunity window: until the new supply completes in 2026–2028, open-air and community centres in the new districts retain the highest occupancy and fastest letting.

Major retail delivery map and destination centres 2026–2030

1 U Walk Qassim Q4 2026

Buraydah · 60,000 sqm GLA · 135+ stores · within the Tijan mixed-use scheme (~1m sqm) · estimated cost SAR 400m · the region's flagship modern retail project

2 New Unaizah Mall 2026–2028

Unaizah · 60,000+ sqm · c. SAR 85m investment · contract signed by Unaizah Municipality in April 2026 to develop and operate an integrated mall on the former mall site · a modern shopping and services destination

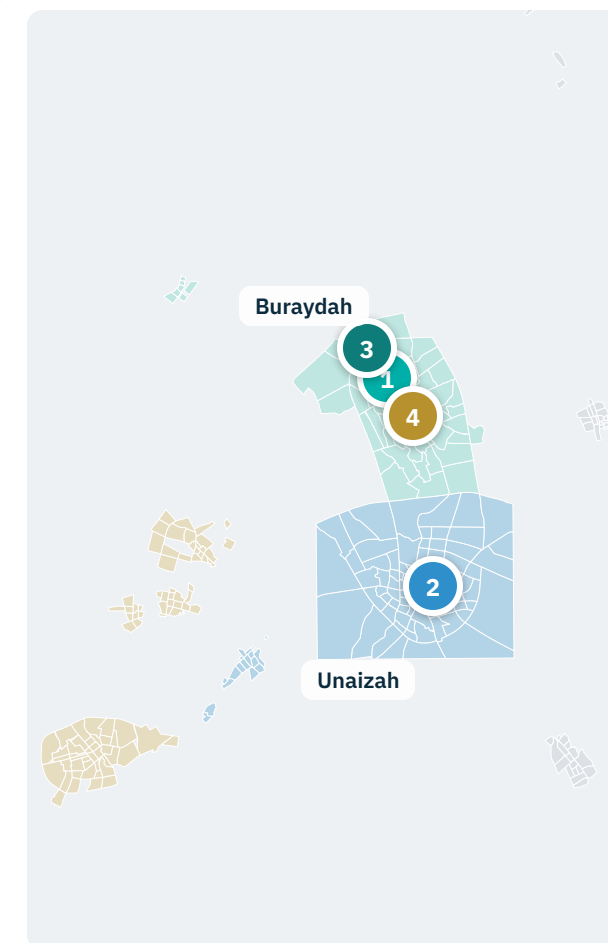
3 Al Qura' Investment Scheme — Buraydah 2026+

Buraydah · 965,000+ sqm · a large-scale development and investment project announced in 2026, including infrastructure, roads, lighting and utility networks to prepare a new site for commercial and urban investment

4 Al Jarda Souq redevelopment — Buraydah 2026–2027

Buraydah · ~5,100 sqm · redevelopment of one of Al-Qassim's historic markets: heritage-style shops, pedestrian and seating areas, combining retail, heritage and the visitor experience

125k+ sqm of modern lettable space planned to 2028 (U Walk + Unaizah mall) — more than double Al Nakheel Mall's GLA, concentrated in open-air and mixed-use destinations.



Approximate project locations on the actual district map of Buraydah and Unaizah

The four pillars of demand and spending in Al-Qassim retail

Lettable area by pillar (upper bound of range)

Retail & shopping 40%

F&B 30%

Leisure 20%

Services

- **Retail and shopping (35%–40%):** Retail remains the core driver of commercial destinations in Al-Qassim, supported by population demand in Buraydah and Unaizah and the expansion of modern centres. Schemes such as U Walk Qassim accelerate the shift to integrated centres combining shopping, dining and leisure.
- **Restaurants and cafés, F&B (25%–30%):** F&B is increasingly a primary attraction in Al-Qassim rather than a complement to retail, especially in open-air destinations and leisure areas in Buraydah and Unaizah, with marked growth in outdoor seating within parks and public destinations.
- **Leisure and experiences (15%–20%):** Family entertainment, events and social experiences are among the fastest-growing components, supported by Al-Qassim seasons and local events: "Mojan Buraydah Summer 2026" alone featured more than 100 events.
- **Services and lifestyle (15%–20%):** Health, beauty, fitness, wellness and daily services grow in importance as shopping centres become integrated everyday destinations serving families and residents throughout the week, not only at weekends.

100+

events at "Mojan Buraydah Summer 2026" — the seasonal leisure engine

135

stores at U Walk Qassim — a step change in tenant mix

10–15

years — anchor tenant leases in daily-services centres

Summary

The winning tenant mix in Al-Qassim starts with everyday retail and food, is anchored by neighbourhood services and family leisure, and concentrates fashion in Buraydah's major centres.

Benchmark comparison: traditional enclosed malls vs open-air centres

	Open-air centres (Strip & Lifestyle Malls)	Enclosed regional malls
Key examples	Open-air destinations, restaurants, cafés and new schemes on the main corridors of Buraydah and Unaizah; U Walk Qassim is the flagship upcoming lifestyle project with 60k sqm GLA and 135+ stores	Al Nakheel Mall in Buraydah and several enclosed malls and centres in Buraydah and Unaizah, focused on conventional retail, local and international brands and daily services
Occupancy	88–94% for modern centres in prime locations, driven by appetite for F&B and leisure brands	82–89% for leading regional centres, with vacancy emerging in unrefurbished space that has not kept pace with leisure and dining
Average rent	850–1,600 SAR/sqm/yr for showrooms and restaurants with direct frontage, with a premium for open-air locations	700–1,350 SAR/sqm/yr — a sharp gap between anchor and in-line stores
Operating edge	Built on restaurants, cafés, leisure, outdoor space and events, suited to the growing consumer climate in Buraydah and Unaizah	A broader tenant base and a year-round air-conditioned environment serving daily and family shopping, but needing more F&B, leisure and experiences to stay competitive

Open-air premium: a rental gap of up to +20% at the upper bound and occupancy around 5 percentage points higher — making the repositioning of space in traditional malls towards F&B and leisure an investment priority.

Geographic distribution and rents by retail corridor in Al-Qassim

1

Northern corridor

North Buraydah – Al Bukayriyah – Uyun
Al Jiwa – Al Asyah

Serves residential expansion north of Buraydah and the agricultural governorates; retail profile: neighbourhood and community centres, supermarkets, F&B, daily services and family leisure, strongest on main roads and city gateways.

1,100 – 1,600

SAR/sqm · 92% occupancy

2

Eastern corridor

East Buraydah – Ash Shimasiyah –
towards Riyadh

An urban and service growth axis towards Riyadh; retail profile: strip retail, showrooms, F&B, automotive services, community centres and mid-sized schemes in new districts, with a rental premium for direct main-road frontage.

900 – 1,300

SAR/sqm · 90% occupancy

3

Western corridor

West Buraydah – Airport – Riyadh Al
Khabra – Ar Rass

Links Buraydah with the western governorates, benefiting from the airport, industrial city and regional roads; retail profile: travel and roadside services, F&B, community centres, medical services, showrooms and logistics-related retail.

800 – 1,200

SAR/sqm · 88% occupancy

4

Southern corridor

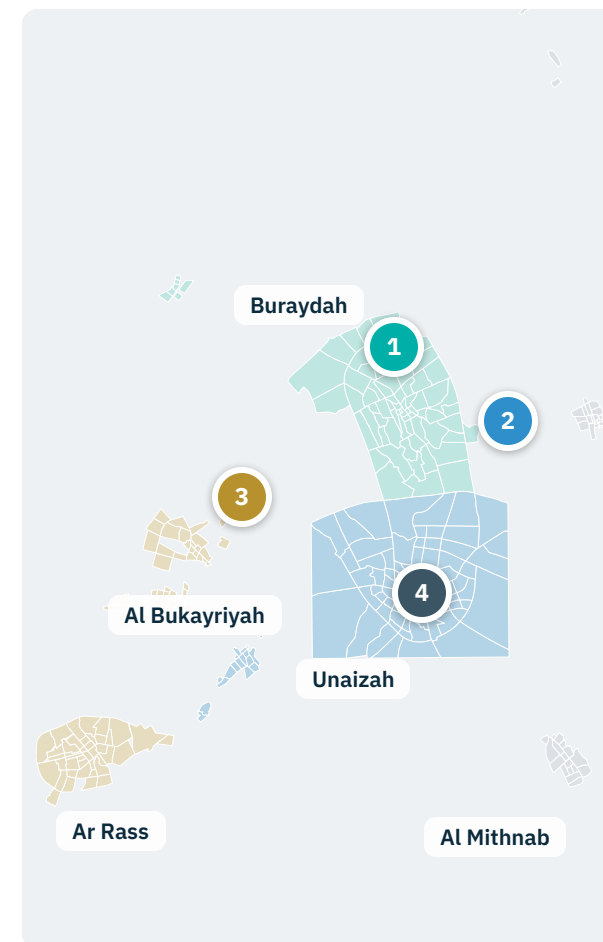
Unaizah – Al Badayea – Al Mithnab –
Qassim–Riyadh road

The strongest retail corridor after Buraydah, drawing on Unaizah's population and commercial weight, visitor flows and southern residential expansion; retail profile: malls and community centres, lifestyle retail, F&B, family leisure and local markets.

950 – 1,450

SAR/sqm · 91% occupancy

Takeaway: the rental gap between North Buraydah and the western corridor is c. 1.4x, with a 4-point occupancy gap – the market rewards residential density and modernity above all.



Retail corridor centres of gravity on Al-Qassim's district map

Strategy pyramid and actionable recommendations for retail

Lifestyle centres and destinations

Lifestyle & Strip Malls: develop local centres of 8,000–15,000 sqm serving residential expansion and new districts in Buraydah, Unaizah and Ar Rass, focused on cafés, restaurants and family leisure — highest yield and fastest letting.

Community services centres

New housing suburbs: secure anchors (supermarket, pharmacy, health and fitness, restaurants and cafés, daily services) on long leases of 10–15 years — stable income that supports financing and exit, especially as new districts grow and demand for nearby services rises.

Repositioning existing malls

Repositioning: convert under-performing space in existing centres in Buraydah and Unaizah to F&B, family leisure, health and fitness and interactive experiences, lengthening dwell time, improving the tenant mix and asset efficiency, and matching the market's shift to more diverse destinations.

Execution matrix

The smart-parking equation

Ample shaded parking and easy car access — the first factor in destination choice in Al-Qassim.

Flexible leases

Base rent plus turnover share for F&B and leisure, and short leases for pop-up stores in festival seasons.

E-commerce integration

Click-and-collect, returns points and micro-fulfilment for rapid delivery within neighbourhood centres.

Pyramid order from the top: highest priority by return versus development effort.

05

Industrial, Logistics & Agriculture

Dashboard and gauges · Supply-chain flow from factory to market ·
Demand drivers and industrial cities · Dates and food processing ·
Opportunities for investors



Dashboard and KPIs: Al-Qassim's highest-occupancy, highest-yield sector

730

operating factories · 4.7% of the Kingdom's total

30.9bn

SAR — total industrial investment in the region

37.4K

industrial workers — a broad operating base

8.5–9.2%

target net yield for warehousing and cold storage

Occupancy and rent by facility type

Market dynamics: demand for modern warehouses and cold-chain facilities exceeds organised supply in serviced locations; Industrial City 1 operates near full capacity (96%) while capacity remains in newer and peripheral cities.

Industrial City 1 — Buraydah		96%
Industrial cities average		77%
Modern warehouses (Grade A) SAR/sqm		~220
Traditional warehouses SAR/sqm		~120

Why does industry and logistics outperform in Al-Qassim?

High occupancy reflects strong demand for warehousing and industrial facilities, driven by Al-Qassim's central position between Riyadh and the northern and western regions, growth in food and agri (dates), pharmaceutical and manufacturing industries, and Industrial City 1's proximity to the airport and rail station.

SAR 700m of new industrial investment in Q1 2025 and 158 factories in Industrial City 1 show continued inflows, while Buraydah dry port and the Qassim 1 energy project (1,800 MW) open a new wave of demand from energy-intensive industry and regional distribution.

Supply-chain flow: from farm and factory to market

Four linked stages define where industrial and logistics property demand concentrates in Al-Qassim.

Link 1

Agricultural production and dates

10.87M palms

More than 10.87 million palms, 584k+ tonnes of dates a year and 25 date factories — the raw base of the Kingdom's largest agricultural value chain.



Link 2

Industrial cities and processing

730 factories

Industrial Cities 1 and 2 in Buraydah and the palm processing project in Unaizah (500k sqm) — packaging, cold storage and food, pharmaceutical and metal manufacturing.



Link 3

Dry port, rail station and airport

974 km

Buraydah dry port, Qassim rail station (SAR network) and Prince Nayef Airport — a regional distribution platform for central, northern and western KSA.



Link 4

Distribution and cold-storage hubs

8.5–9.2%

Grade A warehouses and chilled distribution centres serving e-commerce and food and pharmaceutical distribution at target net yields of 8.5%–9.2%.

The decisive location: the Industrial City 1 – airport – rail station triangle west of Buraydah is where the highest rents and lowest vacancy are recorded.

Required specification: 10–12m clear height, chilled and frozen storage for food, multiple loading docks, rooftop solar and truck manoeuvring yards.

Target tenants: dates and food companies, 3PL and regional distribution, e-commerce, pharmaceuticals, and feed and agri-input suppliers.

Industrial and logistics demand drivers and developer opportunities

The five demand drivers

1

Food industries and dates: 25 date factories, 390k+ tonnes of processing capacity and SAR 313m of processing investment — a value chain that needs cold storage, packaging and distribution.

2

Renewables and energy-intensive industry: The Qassim 1 project (1,800 MW) opens the door to manufacturing, metal and plastics industries and data centres.

3

Regional distribution and e-commerce: A central position between Riyadh, Hail and Madinah makes Al-Qassim a natural distribution hub for central and northern KSA.

4

Health and pharmaceutical cluster: Growth in pharmaceuticals and medical supplies around the Qassim Health Cluster lifts demand for GDP-compliant warehousing.

5

Transport infrastructure: Buraydah dry port, the rail station and airport upgrade lower logistics costs and raise the appeal of nearby sites.

Investment opportunities

Build-to-Suit Grade A warehouses

Developed to tenant specification (dates and food companies, 3PL) on 7–10 year leases near Industrial City 1 and the dry port — the closest to an institutional asset that industrial REITs can acquire.

Cold-storage complexes for dates and food

Chilled and frozen units of 2,000–5,000 sqm in Unaizah and Buraydah serving harvest and export seasons — the clearest gap in the market, with yields up to 9.2%.

Upgrading traditional warehouses

Raising the specification of older warehouses in the industrial cities (height, floors, docks, solar) to close the gap between SAR 120 and 220/sqm rents at limited capital cost.

06

Hospitality & Hotels

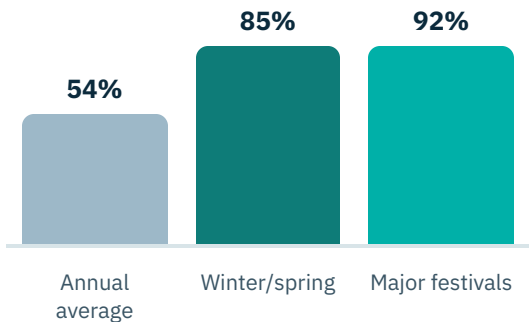
Operating and financial indicators · Demand drivers and guest behaviour · Development and investment economics · Geography of investment hotspots · Seasonality · Risks and hedging · Recommendations



Comprehensive operating and financial dashboard for Al-Qassim’s hotel market

Indicator	Estimated value 2026	Annual change	Analysis and data sources
Total existing hotel supply	c. 6,150 licensed keys	+5.2%	Buraydah c. 3,400 keys, Unaizah 1,650, Ar Rass 650, other governorates c. 450.
Overall annual occupancy	54.2%	+1.8 pts	85%–92% at festival and winter/spring peaks in Buraydah and Unaizah; 50%–55% weekdays.
Average daily rate (ADR)	SAR 365 / night	+4.2%	4/5-star hotels and premium lodges SAR 450–550; serviced apts 320–450; economy 200–290.
RevPAR	SAR 198	+5.5%	Driven by rising passenger traffic through Prince Nayef Airport and more conferences and specialist events.
Total operating revenue	SAR 420 – 520 / room	+3.8%	A rising contribution from F&B, event and exhibition halls, government workshops and business forums.
Gross operating margin	34% – 38%	+1.5%	Low capital and operating costs, notably in serviced apartments and flexibly managed lodges.

Occupancy: annual vs peak



Institutional analysis

A dual-pattern market: corporate delegations, agri-food investment, Qassim University forums and the Health Cluster feed weekday occupancy, while major festivals (Buraydah Dates Carnival, Al Ghada) and rural lodge and farm tourism fill weekends and holidays.

Hotel demand drivers, guest behaviour and spending patterns

Demand segment	Key drivers and feeder events	Daily guest spend	Average stay	Share
Corporate & Agri-Business	Chamber of commerce premises, major food and poultry companies, Qassim University delegations and logistics projects	SAR 650 – 1,100	2.5 – 3.5 nights	41%
Festivals, Events & MICE	Buraydah International Dates Carnival, the Gulf Festival, Al Ghada Festival in Unaizah and King Khalid Civilisation Centre events	SAR 800 – 1,350	2.0 – 2.8 nights	26%
Family Heritage & Leisure	Palm groves, rural lodges, Buraydah Tower, Al Musawkaf traditional souq and Al Khabra heritage village	SAR 700 – 1,200	1.8 – 2.2 nights	23%
Extended Stay & serviced apartments	Visiting doctors and consultants, academic staff, and engineers on infrastructure and central warehouse projects	SAR 350 – 550	10 – 25 nights	10%
Business 41% Festivals 26% Leisure 23% 10%				

Shifts in guest behaviour

Business tourism and agricultural seasons: investor and corporate visits coincide with auction seasons, agricultural output, major food industries and supply chains.

Rural and eco tourism (Agri-Tourism): families prefer lodges, farms and equipped heritage camps over classic hotels at weekends and in winter.

28–35%

F&B and events contribution

Share of operating income from event halls, exhibitions and outside catering at the region's upscale hotels.

Hotel development and investment economics: three categories compared

Financial and development criterion	5-star Luxury	4-star Upscale	Serviced apartments Serviced Living
Build and fit-out cost per key (CapEx/Key)	750k – 1.1m	420 – 620k	300 – 450k
International operator fees (Base + Incentive)	2.0% revenue + 7% GOP	1.8% revenue + 5% GOP	1.5% revenue + 5% GOP
Average annual net cash flow per room	60,000 – 95,000	38,000 – 58,000	32,000 – 50,000
Rate of return (expected IRR)	12.0% – 14.5%	14.5% – 16.5%	16.5% – 19.0%
Payback Period	8.5 – 10.5 years	6.5 – 7.8 years	5.2 – 6.5 years
Values in SAR · Takamol estimates based on hotel development benchmarks in Al-Qassim 2026.			

Up to 60%

of capital cost covered by Tourism Development Fund (TDF) packages for eligible midscale, luxury and rural lodge projects in Al-Qassim

Financial drivers of the sector

Investment funds and franchising:

encouraging local investors to adopt franchise models for midscale brands, lowering development risk and accessing global booking platforms without costly foreign management.

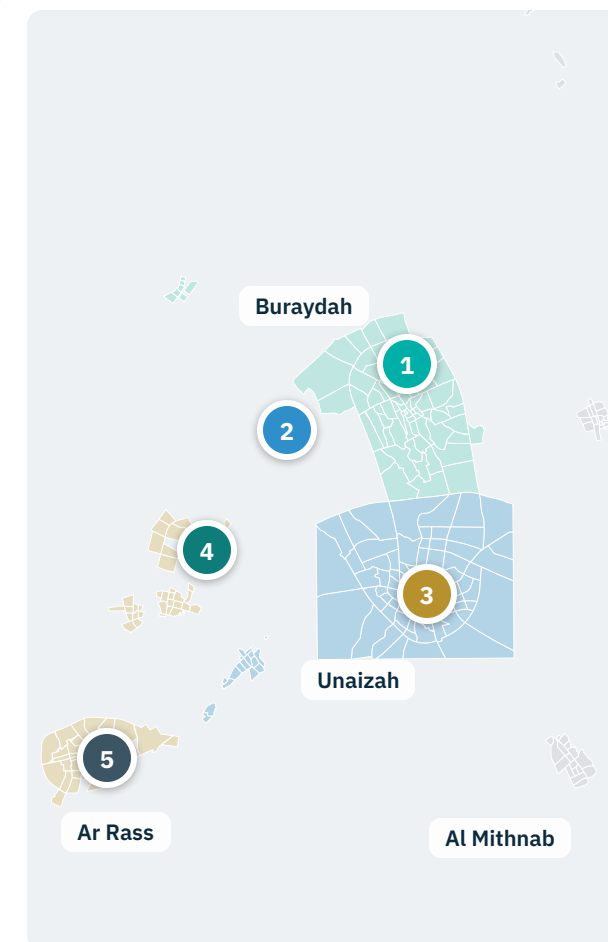
Serviced apartments pay back fastest:

the highest IRR (up to 19%) and shortest payback (5.2–6.5 years) with the lowest operating cost — the best fit for Al-Qassim given demand from professionals and families.

Detailed geography of hotel investment hotspots in Al-Qassim

1	N. Buraydah – King Fahd Rd Business and shopping	Al Othaim Mall, Al Nakheel Plaza, conference centre and corporate HQs; target supply: 4/5-star business hotels, upscale serviced apartments, conference venues.	450 – 750 SAR · target ADR
2	Airport – Qassim University Forums and transit	Prince Nayef Airport, the Al Mulaida campus and logistics zones; target supply: affordable transit hotels and lodging for university guests and medical delegations.	320 – 480 SAR · target ADR
3	Unaizah Governorate Heritage tourism and festivals	Al Musawka souq, Al Ghada parks, palm oases and tourism committee events; target supply: boutique hotels, family serviced apartments and lodges in an updated Najdi style.	350 – 580 SAR · target ADR
4	Rural lodges and agri-tourism Al Bukayriyah, Al Badayea, Al Mithnab	Major palm groves and farms, pomegranate and dates festivals and eco-tourism trails; target supply: eco-resorts and farm-hotel chalets with full leisure services.	400 – 700 SAR · target ADR
5	Ar Rass – western gateway Regional transport corridor	Junction of regional roads towards Madinah, the general hospital and industrial city; target supply: economy 3-star hotels and furnished apartments for field teams.	240 – 360 SAR · target ADR

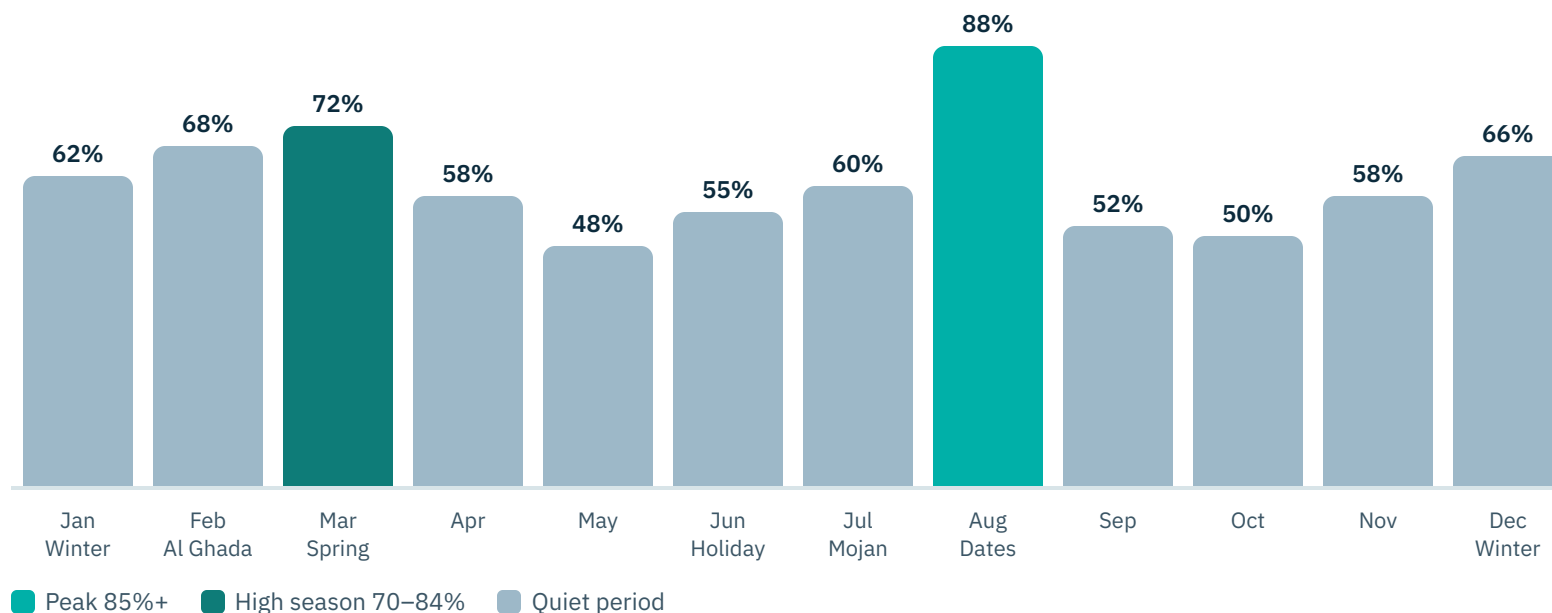
Takeaway: a 3× ADR gap between North Buraydah (750) and Ar Rass (240); rural lodges rival city hotels on rate.



The five hotel investment corridors on Al-Qassim's map

Seasonality: estimated hotel occupancy curve across the year

Takamol's reading of demand rhythm in Al-Qassim — an illustrative estimate from the annual average (54.2%) and festival peaks (85%–92%).



~40 pts

gap between the Dates Carnival peak (August) and the quiet months — the hotel owner's first operational challenge in Al-Qassim

How is seasonality managed?

At peak: dynamic pricing, minimum stays (2–3 nights) and family packages tied to festivals and farms.

Off-peak: contracts with food and poultry companies, university and Health Cluster forums, and hosting government workshops and weddings.

In design: flexible dual-key assets that switch between hotel and long-stay serviced living for professionals.

Strategic hedging and operational mitigation in Al-Qassim

Challenge / Risk	Impact	Strategic hedge and executive mitigation
Sharp seasonality tied to the dates and spring festivals	High	Create year-round off-peak packages, run regular specialist forums (agricultural, health, education) and promote rural weekend tourism to lift occupancy in quiet months.
Competition from furnished apartments and unlicensed retreats	Medium	Contract recognised branded midscale operators for guest trust and GDS connectivity, and draw on Ministry of Tourism licensing enforcement.
High cooling and energy costs in a dry continental climate	Medium	Apply strict Saudi Building Code insulation standards, smart building management systems (BMS) and solar solutions to cut operating bills by 20%–25%.
Short average length of stay (LOS)	Low–Medium	Design joint tourism routes linking Buraydah, Unaizah and the heritage governorates, with bundled stays including farm and souq tours to add tourist nights.

Actionable recommendations for hospitality investors in Al-Qassim

01

Capture the serviced apartment (Extended Stay) and rural lodge opportunity

Achieve the fastest payback (under 6 years) and highest IRR (above 17%) by building serviced hotel apartments for health and education staff contracts in Buraydah, alongside eco rural lodges that leverage the region's unique agricultural character.

IRR 16.5%–19.0% · Payback 5.2–6.5 years

02

Focus on upper-midscale hotels in Buraydah and Unaizah

Fill the quality gap with modern 3- and 4-star hotels on King Fahd Road and around the airport and Qassim University at considered rates (SAR 320–550), offering a professional stay for business delegations and festival visitors.

Target ADR SAR 320–550 · the widest gap in the market

03

Partner with financing funds and adopt the franchise model

Draw on competitive Tourism Development Fund (TDF) support covering up to 60% of project cost, and adopt franchising of global brands to cut direct management cost and lift operating margins under local management.

Up to 60% concessional finance · franchise over management

07

Legislative & Regulatory Framework

Non-Saudi ownership law and approved zones • White Land Tax and supply release • Real estate contributions law • Brokerage and the Ejar network • Real Estate Registry • Credit environment and REITs



Restructuring the market, protecting consumers and attracting capital

100%

full ownership for non-Saudis in the approved investment and industrial zones of Buraydah and Unaizah

~7.5%

total transaction costs (5% RETT + brokerage commission capped at 2.5% by law)

22,937

properties recorded in the Real Estate Registry across 28 districts in Buraydah and Unaizah

Ownership scope in Al-Qassim

Zones approved for 100% non-Saudi ownership include the investment and industrial zones of Buraydah and Unaizah, MODON Industrial Cities 1 and 2 in Buraydah, logistics development corridors around Prince Nayef Airport and the SAR rail station, and classified agricultural and industrial assets.

Non-Saudi property ownership is permitted within the geographic zones and controls set by the Non-Saudi Real Estate Ownership Law and its implementing regulations issued by Council of Ministers resolutions, and REGA's instructions for Al-Qassim.

Digital pathway: mandatory property verification, issuance of no-objection certificates and instant electronic linkage with the Real Estate Registry (RER) via REGA's official platform.

From speculation to operating sustainability

2025–2026 brought radical regulatory decisions that changed the rules in Al-Qassim as across the Kingdom: the Non-Saudi Ownership Law, the three-phase expansion of the White Land Tax, the new Real Estate Contributions Law, and the Brokerage Law with the FAL licence.

Target group: companies in food, agriculture and logistics, suppliers to strategic projects, Premium Residency holders and international investors — enabling ownership of head offices, central warehouses and staff housing in the approved zones.

White Land Tax and the release of urban supply in Al-Qassim

WLT

The three phases of the White Land Tax

Releasing held land within the urban boundary

Phase one

Undeveloped raw land of 10,000 sqm or more within the declared boundary.

Phase two

Developed land of 10,000 sqm or more owned by one party, or one owner's plots totalling 10,000 sqm or more within a single approved scheme.

Phase three

Developed land of 5,000 sqm or more owned by one party within a city, to spur direct development inside completed districts.

2.5%

of land value per year — the base levy

15M sqm

of land brought into development or ownership transfer

Developer opportunity: landowners under levy pressure in Buraydah and Unaizah are more open to joint-venture development — lowering land cost and opening new schemes.

FX

Financial and urban impact

From land-banking to development

Owners obliged to pay the annual levy

On plots along Buraydah's strategic corridors (north and west of the city, King Fahd Road, Omar bin Al-Khattab Road) and in Unaizah, pushing owners to accelerate development or sell to release new liquidity.

100% of levies recycled

To fund infrastructure and connect water, power and sewerage to approved schemes, and to support NHC housing and development suburbs in Buraydah and Unaizah.

Regulatory delivery data

The urban boundaries of Buraydah and Unaizah are included in the phase-three implementation decisions, with millions of square metres surveyed and invoiced within the target scope; land subject to the levy officially reached around 15 million sqm.

Regulatory transformation: four phases that redefined the market

01

Regulation and governance

Launch of the Brokerage Law, the FAL licence and implementing regulations to protect transactions, and the creation of REGA as a unified regulator.

02

Digitisation and documentation

The Ejar platform and the unified Real Estate Registry (RER) to record title electronically — 22,937 properties across 28 districts in Buraydah and Unaizah — linking deals to transparent official data.

03

Financial openness and liquidity

Updated REIT regulations, the new Real Estate Contributions Law, the off-plan sale and lease law (Wafi) and bank escrow accounts.

04

Internationalisation and investment attraction

Expansion of Premium Residency and modernisation of foreign ownership rules in Al-Qassim's industrial and investment zones, tying ownership to direct-investment incentives.

According to Knight Frank, Saudi real estate is no longer an unregulated market governed by individual discretion; it is an institutional environment governed by REGA legislation. This shift from informality to digital governance lifted the Kingdom's JLL Real Estate Transparency Index score, creating a safe environment for institutional investors, foreign and local alike — with direct effects on regional markets such as Al-Qassim.

The new Real Estate Contributions Law and capital protection mechanisms

RC

Real Estate Contributions Law

Dual oversight and institutional regulation

Dual oversight

Contributions fall under direct supervision and joint coordination between REGA and the Capital Market Authority, with developers required to be classified as licensed, qualified institutional entities.

Crowdfunding channels

Licensed proptech platforms let individuals and institutions subscribe in accessible amounts, giving developers fast capital to build smart residential schemes, retail complexes and supply-chain warehouses in Buraydah and Unaizah.

Governance flow

Feasibility study and engineering plan → REGA and CMA approval → escrow account and custodian appointed → periodic engineering and accounting oversight → disbursement by completion milestones → liquidation and profit distribution.

The new law closed the file on historically stalled contributions and restored full investor confidence in Al-Qassim.

FAL

Brokerage Law and the Ejar network

The FAL licence and professional requirements

The FAL real estate licence

Mandatory completion of accredited Saudi Real Estate Institute training and a FAL licence to practise brokerage, marketing, property and facility management — raising professionalism and trust in Buraydah, Unaizah and the governorates.

Regulating marketing and digital advertising

A ban on unlicensed property adverts, mandatory advertising licences with an approved number, and direct technical linkage of platforms and apps with REGA to curb fictitious listings and irregular speculation.

Commission governance

Brokerage commission capped at 2.5% of deal value, lease commission limited to the first year only, and criminalisation of double commissions or undisclosed sums in documented contracts.

Legal and financial impact: the unified electronic lease via the Ejar network is an enforceable instrument allowing direct execution without litigation, cutting rental disputes in Al-Qassim's enforcement courts.

The Real Estate Registry (RER) and conclusive title

How the system works — from survey to conclusive title

1

The technical concept of title registration

A unique "property number" and digital spatial identity for every plot and residential or commercial unit in Buraydah, Unaizah and the governorates, tied to 3D geodetic coordinates to prevent any duplication of deeds.



2

The pivotal role of the Etmam centre

In partnership with Al-Qassim Municipality and governorate municipalities, accelerating approval of residential, commercial and industrial schemes and the issue of building permits and infrastructure certificates.



3

Absolute, incontestable title

The registry deed carries absolute judicial and regulatory probative force, incontestable once statutory objection periods lapse; official announcements covered registry work for more than 22,937 properties across over 28 districts in Buraydah and Unaizah.

22,937

properties in the Real Estate Registry,
Buraydah and Unaizah

28

districts covered by the registry roll-out

Credit environment, mortgage finance and REITs

SAMA policy: a maximum loan-to-value (LTV) of 90% for citizens' first homes has strengthened Al-Qassim households' ability to buy compact villas and duplexes, alongside tighter developer-finance standards and escrow accounts.

REITs: funds are targeting logistics assets, central cold stores and leading retail and education complexes in Buraydah and Unaizah, and activating sale-and-leaseback strategies with major food companies.

Enabling banks and finance companies to register mortgages electronically through the registry has cut credit risk and strengthened institutional finance flows to developers; the real estate NPL ratio is below 1.8%.

Financial impact matrix: White Land Tax, RETT and first-home exemption

	White Land Tax	Real Estate Transaction Tax (RETT)	First-home exemption
Rate / mechanism	2.5% of land value per year (three implementation phases)	5% flat on the value of the property transaction	1,000,000 SAR — tax exemption ceiling for the first home
Direct objective	Counter land-banking and push owners to develop	Replaces 15% VAT on property	Support citizen home ownership
Impact on market activity	Release c. 15m sqm and expand residential supply within the urban boundaries of Buraydah and Unaizah	Eases liquidity burdens and speeds asset turnover between companies and individuals	Stimulates sales of compact villas and duplexes in the SAR 850k – 1.25m price band

The advanced phases of the White Land Tax in Buraydah and Unaizah are among the strongest drivers of supply release in Al-Qassim: they have curbed land-banking within the urban boundary and pushed major owners either to sell to developers or enter development partnerships. A stable 5% RETT with first-home exemptions has kept transaction flows flexible.

08

Real Estate Transaction Volumes

A reading of Real Estate Registry transactions in Al-Qassim during 2026: residential · commercial · land · industrial and agricultural · comparison and conclusion



Residential sector: 14,282 transactions worth SAR 5.03bn

14,282

residential transactions in 2026 — c. 7% of the Kingdom's total

5.03bn

SAR — total residential transaction value

352k

SAR — average residential transaction value

21.36M sqm

total area of vacant land traded

District / zone	Transactions	Transaction value	Residential price per sqm	Average transaction value
Buraydah	1,101	SAR 531m	SAR 667/sqm	≈ SAR 482k
Al Mithnab	461	SAR 62m	SAR 221/sqm	≈ SAR 134k
Unaizah	271	SAR 111m	SAR 549/sqm	≈ SAR 410k
Al Badayea	240	SAR 23m	SAR 108/sqm	≈ SAR 96k
Ar Rass	148	SAR 41m	SAR 354/sqm	≈ SAR 277k
Al Bukayriyah	147	SAR 49m	SAR 225/sqm	≈ SAR 333k

Reading the activity

Property activity in Al-Qassim reflects balanced, sustainable, non-speculative liquidity: the residential sector recorded 14,282 sales worth SAR 5.03bn in total (an average of SAR 352k per deal), around 7% of all property transactions in the Kingdom.

What it means

A broad residential market built on affordable price bands and family-sized units, with an average deal under a third of Riyadh's — a competitive advantage in entry ticket and appeal for housing-support programmes.

Commercial sector: fewer deals, higher value, larger areas

153

commercial transactions recorded in the Real Estate Registry in 2026

157.3M

SAR — total value of commercial transactions

1.03m

SAR — average commercial deal (2.9× the average residential deal)

1.36M

sqm — total area traded · average price c. SAR 116/sqm

Residential vs commercial — relative comparison



What it means

Commercial property activity in Al-Qassim is smaller than in the Kingdom's main markets but active, supported by Buraydah, Unaizah and the commercial and logistics corridors, with the greatest opportunities in commercial land, community centres, modern retail and mixed-use schemes. The average commercial deal (SAR 1.03m) reflects the asset profile: development land, warehouses and showrooms on the corridors.

Vacant land and the industrial sector: from the Real Estate Registry

21.36M

sqm of vacant land traded
through the Real Estate
Registry

15M sqm

land brought into development
or ownership transfer by the
White Land Tax

730

operating factories · 77%
industrial city occupancy

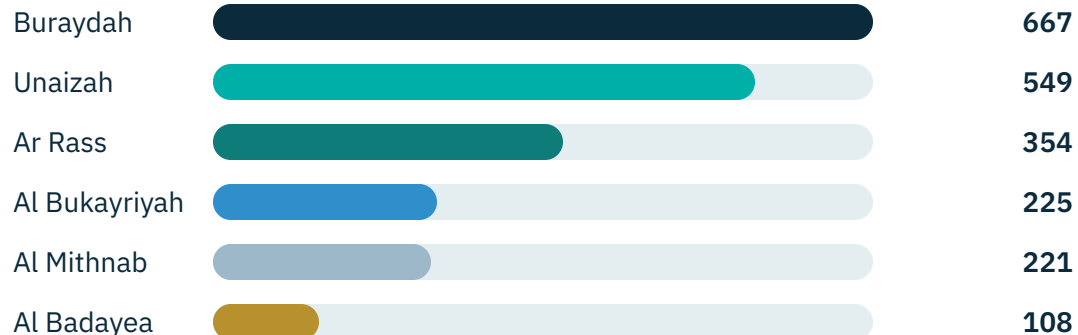
30.9bn

SAR — industrial investment ·
37.4k workers

700M

SAR — new industrial
investment Q1 2025

Residential price per sqm by governorate (SAR/sqm) — 2026 transactions



Al-Qassim's land market is heterogeneous: values rise most in Buraydah and Unaizah and on the commercial corridors and urban expansion areas, while Ar Rass, Al Bukayriyah, Al Badayea and Al Mithnab offer lower entry costs and larger areas — widening residential, commercial, industrial and logistics development opportunities.

What it means

An active, multi-use land market led by residential and commercial land, alongside industrial, logistics and agricultural land in some governorates. Prices vary by city, district, use and corridor position; the greatest value concentrates in the urban zones of Buraydah and Unaizah as the White Land Tax brought around 15m sqm into active development or ownership transfer.

Agriculture and food industries: the dates capital

25

date factories in the region

10.87M

palms — the Kingdom's densest palm population

584K+ t

annual dates production

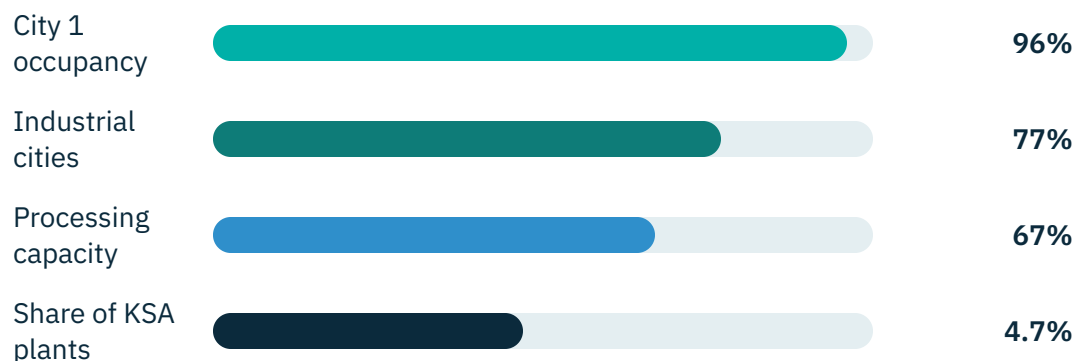
390K+ t

dates processing capacity

313M

SAR — processing investment in the dates sector

Industrial and agricultural base — selected indicators (relative to upper bound)



Al-Qassim shows a diverse property market and economy supported by a stable population base and strong activity in residential, commercial, agricultural, industrial and logistics sectors, with investment weight in Buraydah and Unaizah and growth opportunities extending to Ar Rass, Al Bukayriyah, Al Badayea and the other governorates.

Closing the transactions section

The agricultural economy and food industries give the region a clear competitive edge, alongside urban expansion, infrastructure development, commercial schemes and modern destinations — creating opportunities in housing, developed land, retail and community centres, warehousing and logistics, and agri-food industries.

09

Takamol View: Opportunities and How We Help

Ten ranked investment opportunities · Investor matrix by capital and horizon · Takamol Advanced and its services · Real Forsa and Real Invest · Sources and methodology

Ten investment opportunities in Al-Qassim 2026 – ranked

1

Grade A warehouses and cold storage near Industrial City 1 and dry port

96% occupancy · 8.5%–9.2% net yield · Build-to-Suit for dates and food firms

Logistics

2

Serviced hotel apartments for health and academic staff, Buraydah

IRR 16.5%–19% · 5.2–6.5 year payback · Health Cluster and university demand

Hospitality

3

Modern apartments for sale and rent near the university and Health Cluster

7.5%–9% yield · fastest letting · entry ticket c. SAR 290k

Residential

4

Open-air lifestyle centres in North Buraydah and Unaizah

8–15k sqm · 88–94% occupancy · rent SAR 850–1,600/sqm

Retail

5

Compact villas and duplexes 250–320 sqm with MMC and off-plan sales

75% of purchase intentions · SAR 850k – 1.25m · 22–28% margin

Residential

6

Rural lodges and agri-tourism in Unaizah, Al Bukayriyah and Al Badayea

ADR SAR 400–700 · TDF finance up to 60% · festival season

Hospitality

7

Compact modern offices on King Abdullah Road and North Buraydah

97% occupancy · rent SAR 400–620/sqm · window before Tijan 2028

Offices

8

Community services centres in the new NHC suburbs

10–15 year leases · stable income · 8,500 units coming around them

Retail

9

JV partnerships with landowners under White Land Tax pressure

15m sqm entered development · lower land cost · north and west Buraydah

Land

10

Upgrading traditional warehouses and packing complexes in industrial cities

Lift rents from SAR 120 to 220/sqm at limited capital cost

Value-add

Investor matrix: which opportunity suits whom?

Individual investor

Capital SAR 0.3 – 2m

Horizon: 5–8 years · Goal: recurring income + capital growth

Modern 2–3 bedroom apartment near the university or Health Cluster

Compact duplex in North Buraydah for housing-support buyers

Off-plan (Wafi) unit in the NHC suburbs

Target yield: 6.0% – 9.0%

Mid-size investor / family office

Capital SAR 2 – 20m

Horizon: 5–10 years · Goal: income-producing, liquid asset

Build-to-Rent residential block for health and education staff

Open-air strip mall in a dense northern district

Cold store of 2,000–5,000 sqm for dates companies

Target yield: 7.5% – 9.2%

Property developer

Projects SAR 20 – 200m

Horizon: 2–4 year development cycle · Goal: margin + exit

Compact villas 250–320 sqm with MMC and off-plan sales

Serviced hotel apartments under franchise with TDF finance

JV with a landowner in north/west Buraydah

Target margin: 22% – 28% · IRR 14%–19%

Institutional investor / funds

SAR 200m+

Horizon: 7–15 years · Goal: core income assets on long leases

Grade A warehouse portfolio let to food companies on 7–10 year leases

Sale & leaseback of major dates and poultry company assets

4-star hotel / rural lodges via a closed development fund

Target yield: 7.5% – 9.5% · REIT-listable

Takamol Advanced: your advisory partner in real estate decisions

Takamol Advanced Company (TAC) is a Saudi–Emirati partnership specialised in real estate and investment advisory, combining local market expertise with digital analytics to deliver investment decisions built on data rather than impression. We serve developers, private investors, family offices and funds across the Kingdom and the GCC.

Market research and reports

District-level reports, opportunity maps and sector KPIs.

Feasibility and valuation

Modelling, highest-and-best-use, valuation and deal structuring.

Investment advisory

Portfolio building, opportunity selection and due diligence.

Development advisory

Optimal product, use mix, pricing and launch strategy.

Foreign investor service

Non-Saudi ownership and Premium Residency support, end to end.

An integrated digital ecosystem

Real Forsa to discover opportunities and Real Invest to analyse them — our own tools that turn this report into a decision.

Why Takamol? Analysis at corridor and district level, not just the city · figures tied to operable feasibility models · a team combining Saudi and Emirati expertise · full transparency on sources and methodology.



From report to decision: Real Forsa & Real Invest

Two Takamol Advanced platforms that complete this report — one presents the opportunities, the other analyses them.



Real Forsa

Proptech opportunities marketplace · realforssa.sa

The proptech marketplace for real estate opportunities within the Takamol ecosystem: it curates selected opportunities across the Kingdom — development land, income-producing assets, development partnerships and off-plan products — and presents them to Saudi, GCC and international investors with unified, transparent data.

- The Al-Qassim opportunities in this report (warehousing and cold storage, serviced apartments, open-air centres, rural lodges...) are presented as browsable, trackable opportunities.
- Filter by city, sector, capital and target yield.
- Direct contact with the Takamol team for due diligence and deal structuring.

realforssa.sa



Real Invest

Investment analysis and advisory tool

Takamol's automated analysis and feasibility tool: enter the land or asset data (location, area, use, cost) and receive an instant preliminary feasibility study — cash flows, IRR, payback period and sensitivity analysis — built on the same market indicators presented in this report.

IRR

Internal rate of return

NPV

Net present value

Payback

Payback period

Run the feasibility of your Al-Qassim project in Real Invest

Sources, methodology and disclaimer

Official sources

Real Estate Registry and Ministry of Justice — transaction data (2026)

GASTAT — population, income, inflation

Real Estate General Authority (REGA) — laws and regulations

Saudi Central Bank (SAMA) — mortgage finance

ZATCA — RETT and land levies

Al-Qassim Municipality and governorate municipalities — permits and investment contracts

Saudi Authority for Industrial Cities (MODON) — industrial cities

Ministry of Tourism and TDF · National Center for Palms and Dates

Market & benchmark sources

NHC and developer announcements (Tijan / U Walk)

Invest Saudi — offered investment opportunities

JLL reports — sector yields and transparency index

Knight Frank reports — Premium Residency and governance

CBRE reports — Non-Saudi Ownership Law

Takamol field surveys of rents and occupancy 2026

Official open geographic district data (maps)

Takamol Riyadh and Jeddah reports 2026 (for comparison)

Methodological notes

Values in SAR · annual rates compare with the same period of 2025 · figures preceded by "c." or "around" are estimates · percentage splits, monthly curves and yield models are illustrative, built on the report's averages · average mall occupancy (89%) is a national benchmark, not a direct Al-Qassim figure · project locations on maps are approximate.

Disclaimer

This report is prepared for general informational and analytical purposes and does not constitute investment advice, an offer or a solicitation to invest in any asset. Takamol Advanced has relied on sources it believes to be reliable without guaranteeing their accuracy or completeness, and figures may change as official data is updated. Investors should conduct independent due diligence and obtain specialist advice before any decision. © Takamol Advanced 2026 — all rights reserved.



Thank you for your trust

This report is part of Takamol Advanced's series on the Saudi real estate market — Riyadh · Jeddah · Al-Qassim · Eastern Province · Makkah · Madinah · Dammam. For a detailed edition on a specific sector or corridor, or a feasibility study for your project in Al-Qassim, get in touch.

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